

Business Model Canvas

Designed for:

Change in Duolingo Features

Designed by:

Date:

Version:

Key Partners

- Educational institutions
- Certification bodies
- AI technology providers
- Employers (language training)
- Researchers in learning science and pedagogy

Key Activities

- Designing **new learning modes** (e.g., strategy-based, problem-solving formats)
- Expanding AI-assisted learning tools
- Feature-level experimentation (A/B testing sentiment vs conversion)
- Content adaptation across modes
- Maintaining fairness and transparency in freemium design

Key Resources

- Gamification and UX design expertise
- AI / NLP infrastructure
- Learning data at scale
- Brand reputation as a free-learning platform
- Existing subscription base

Value Propositions

For Free Users

- Unrestricted learning access under the **Heart system**
- Performance-based friction (mistakes matter, effort rewarded)
- Fair, non-punitive learning experience
- Exposure to innovative learning modes (basic versions)

For Paid Users

- **Value-added features,**
 - Advanced learning modes (e.g., expanded Chess-style grammar/logic games)
 - AI-powered explanations, feedback, and tutoring
 - Personalized learning paths and diagnostics
 - Deep analytics (error patterns, mastery forecasts)
 - Faster progression tools (smart reviews, adaptive drills)

Customer Relationships

- **Free users**
 - Trust-based relationship
 - Learning autonomy respected
 - Transparent distinction between free and paid benefits
- **Paid users**
 - Personalization and coaching-style interaction
 - Clear ROI from subscription

Channels

- Mobile app (primary)
- Web platform
- In-app prompts triggered by learning needs (not hard limits)
- Social features (leagues, sharing progress)

Customer Segments

Free Learners

Paid Subscribers

Cost Structure

- R&D for new modes and AI features
- Customer support
- Content creation and localization
- UX research and experimentation
- Marketing and partnerships

Revenue Streams

- **Subscriptions (primary)**
- **Value-based upsells**
Mode expansions (advanced Chess mode, mastery challenges)

Logics:

1. Under Heart system, duolingo's paid subscribers have been increased at an increasing rate from 2020 to 2024.
2. Chess mode's popularity indicates possibility for innovative features.